

A rite of passage

Building your own PC has become a rite of passage for those born in the digital age, or as they're referred to these days – Digital Natives. Some would argue that the PC market is dying and they wouldn't be wrong from a purely numbers perspective. While the overall market has been on a steady decline thanks to the fact that mobile phones have begun to replace some of the tasks traditionally performed by a PC, there still exists and will continue to exist a strong market as the sheer performance provided by PCs is way ahead of anything that phones of the same generation can provide.

Over the last couple of years, there has been a shift in the PC community as more people who only needed the PC for casual needs moved away from building systems and got themselves pre-made systems or laptops or any of the million variants therein. Hence, the PC building scene has now become dominated by enthusiasts who want more. More customisability, more power, more performance, more control, more flexibility ... more everything! The very act of building your own machine is a very personal affair, at least we, the members of the PCMasterRace, would like to believe so. It's the act that has brought many a PC enthusiast together. Something that we like to reminisce about when we meet other members of the PCMasterRace.

In this FastTrack, we start you off with a simple overview of the functions of each component. We hope that this cursory information will hook you into the world of PC building. After that, we take you through a more in-depth look at the same components but each chapter looks at multiple suggestions for PC configurations. We've labelled them according to different price points. So, if you want a Basic Rig, all you need to read are just the